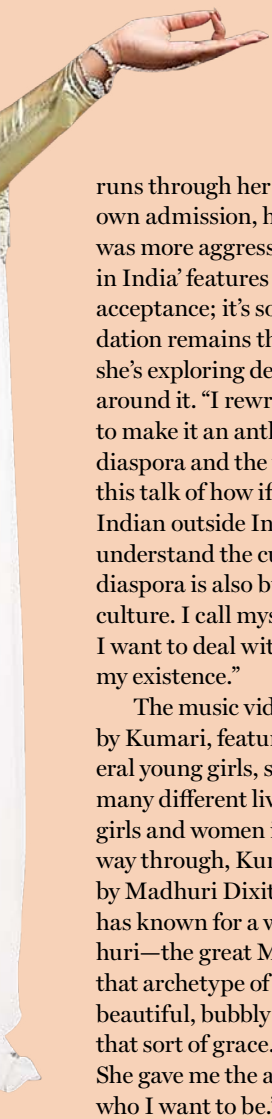
Fall Out Boy. She has worked in Bollywood. While working with Gwen Stefani, she had a revelation. "I cannot half-ass my music career. I can sit here and write songs [for others] forever, and people will think that songs written by a South Asian woman are good enough. But she's not good enough to sing them. It ignited in me the feeling that if my words are good enough to sell millions of records, why can't I do it with my face, my identity, my culture?"

A central theme of identity



runs through her work. By her own admission, her earlier music was more aggressive, but 'Made in India' features growth and acceptance; it's softer. The foundation remains the same, but she's exploring deeper emotions around it. "I rewrote the lyrics to make it an anthem for the diaspora and the world. There's this talk of how if you're an Indian outside India, you don't understand the culture. But the diaspora is also building its own culture. I call myself the bridge. I want to deal with the duality of my existence."

The music video, co-directed by Kumari, features several young girls, symbolic of the many different lives and faces of girls and women in India. Halfway through, Kumari is joined by Madhuri Dixit, whom she has known for a while. "Madhuri—the great MD!—gave me that archetype of how to be that beautiful, bubbly Indian woman, that sort of grace. Sexy and fun. She gave me the archetype of who I want to be." ■

- Akhil Sood

MUSIC

GOING LIVE

As live concerts return, slowly and cautiously, we pick a handful you should mark your calendars for

Asha Bhosle Live with the Bengal Tigers
Shanmukhananda Hall, Mumbai
June 25

Perhaps one of the greatest living singers in India, Asha Bhosle will pay tribute to the four 'Bengal Tigers' of Indian music—S.D. Burman, R.D. Burman, Salil Chowdhury, and Hemant Kumar. Accompanied by singer Shaan and her grandson Chintu Bhosle, she will sing songs composed by these legends and share stories about each.

JUSTIN BIEBER
Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, Delhi
October 18

As the country, and indeed the world, tries its best to move away from one kind of fever, there's another one approaching: Bieber Fever. October sees pop music sensation Justin Bieber, global superstar with hordes of fans (and nearly as many haters), make his return to India for a stadium concert as part of his Justice World Tour.

NCPA BANDISH: A TRIBUTE TO LEGENDARY INDIAN COMPOSERS
Tata Theatre, Mumbai
July 15

Mumbai's National Centre for Performing Arts (NCPA), Mumbai, will host a special three-day event to celebrate 75 years of India's independence. Paying tribute to some great Indian composers of the past century, a range of well-known artists—Rahul Deshpande and Ulhas Kashalkar among them—are set to perform their renowned *bandishes*.

SOULMATE: SUMMER OF LOVE TOUR
The Moonshine Project, Hyderabad
June 10

Soulmate have been around for nearly two decades and yet they remain as unstoppable and formidable as ever. Through their music, the band explores the essence of the blues, the soul of the art form, while venturing into funk, rock 'n' roll, R&B, and so forth. Holding it all together is Tipriti Kharbangar's unforgettable voice. The band is touring the country as part of its 'Summer of Love' tour.

SHANKAR MAHADEVAN
LADY ANDAL SCHOOL AUDITORIUM, CHENNAI
July 10

Shankar Mahadevan has done it all. Alongside his immense popularity in Bollywood as a singer and composer, the maestro seems capable of pulling off just about anything—classical music or global fusion. He takes the stage for a concert in Chennai in July, where he will be accompanied by an orchestra and other playback singers.

AMAAN ALI KHAN
Kalamandir, Kolkata
June 19

Let the sounds of the sarod wash over you in this solo recital by Amaan Ali Khan, son and disciple of the great Ustad Amjad Ali Khan. Amaan has, over the years, made his mark in both classical music and the world of popular and mainstream music. For his performance in Kolkata, he will be accompanied by Ojas Adhiya and Archik Banerjee on the tabla.

BALLY SAGOO
Pyramid Lounge and Club, Chandigarh
June 25

Having helped spearhead the British bhangra revolution of the '90s, Bally Sagoo's legacy as a stalwart of Punjabi pop music is precisely the kind of stuff that music history is made of. As he now shuffles between releasing music, DJing and running a record label, Sagoo will perform in Chandigarh later this month for a performance that's bound to be memorable. ■

- Akhil Sood